

Solar System Research: Evidence Desk

I can research one Solar System focus using suitable sources, accurate notes and a clear source record.

A focused question

use evidence

Accurate notes in your own words

use evidence

A source record another person

can check

use evidence

[Open the original interactive lesson](#)

What success looks like

- Ask a focused research question about the Solar System.
- Select useful information and paraphrase it accurately.
- Record where each fact came from and flag claims that need checking.

Retrieve and reconnect

- Last lesson: why were three views stronger than one?
- Last week: state one model limitation from the shape lab.
- Earlier space learning: state one fact about a planet and how you know it.
- Lead-in: what makes a research question focused enough to answer?

You find three different statements about Jupiter. Which would you use first? Commit before the source check.

Think first. Point, say, sign or write your choice. Give one reason.

- A. The shortest statement, because it is quickest to copy.
- B. A relevant statement from a named, suitable source that can be checked.
- C. The statement on the brightest page.

Look closely · what is the evidence?

Question first: decide exactly what you need to find out.

Source check: identify author or organisation, relevance and date where available.

Note carefully: preserve meaning, use your own words and record the source.

Look closely · what is the evidence?

QUESTION FIRST

"How long is a day on Jupiter, and why?"

A precise question rejects most pages before you read them.

Question first

SOURCE A

Space agency page
author: named agency · updated 2024

SOURCE B

Video comment
no author · no date

SOURCE C

Encyclopaedia entry
author: named editor · 2019

Three source cards

NOTE

Jupiter: day ≈ 10 hours (fast rotation).
Own words. Number + unit kept.
Source: named agency page, 2024.

A note in own words with its source

Words we will use

- source — where information came from
- credible — reasonable to trust
- paraphrase — same meaning, your words

Watch the model

- Turn a broad topic into one answerable question, such as: How long does Mars take to orbit the Sun?
- Check whether a source names a science organisation or author, answers the question and gives information you can compare with another source.
- Mark each candidate claim keep, check or reject. A professional-looking page is not evidence by itself.

Which note is ready to use in a Solar System research record?

- A. 'Mars is cool!!!' copied from an unnamed post.
 - B. 'Mars takes about 687 Earth days to orbit the Sun' paraphrased, with the checked source recorded.
 - C. A full paragraph pasted from the first search result with no source name.
- Commit to an answer. Show the evidence you used. Listen, then revise if needed.

Build the explanation

- Read one short source statement, look away, then write the key meaning in fewer words.
- Compare the note with the source: keep number, unit and relationship accurate; repair any changed meaning.
- Add the source code and a check status. If two cards differ, record the difference rather than hiding it.

Find and repair the misconception

Research glitch: copy a full paragraph because the source is accurate.

A. Keep it: accuracy makes copying acceptable.

B. Repair it: paraphrase the needed meaning accurately and record the source.

C. Repair it: remove the source so the wording looks original.

Solar System evidence desk

Route each research item to keep, check or reject, then freeze the decisions you can justify.

- Read one source-and-note card.
- Commit it to keep, check or reject.
- Use feedback to repair the decision.
- Freeze at least two decisions and explain the rule used.

Use the numbered cards in your pupil pack. Take turns to choose, justify and check. You may direct a partner to move a card.

Choose a group · defend your placement

- Keep for the record
- Check before use
- Reject for this question

State one decision rule and show how a frozen card meets or fails it.

Your independent mission

Choose one local Solar System question and prepare a three-fact research record for the next lesson.

Record: One chosen question, three accurate own-word facts, at least two source codes, one agreement check and one card to check or leave out.

Choose your support and challenge

- Supported: Choose one question and use its three local cards to complete three short source-note rows.
- Standard: Choose one question, compare its three local cards and prepare three facts in your own words.
- Stretch: Research a question with a comparison or explanation, cross-check claims and note any uncertainty or disagreement.

Show what you know

Explain why one chosen note is ready for a presentation and one other item is not.

Point to, read or explain the evidence you made. Choose one next step after the adult has listened.